

SOUTH SUDAN – NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

June – July 2026 Analysis

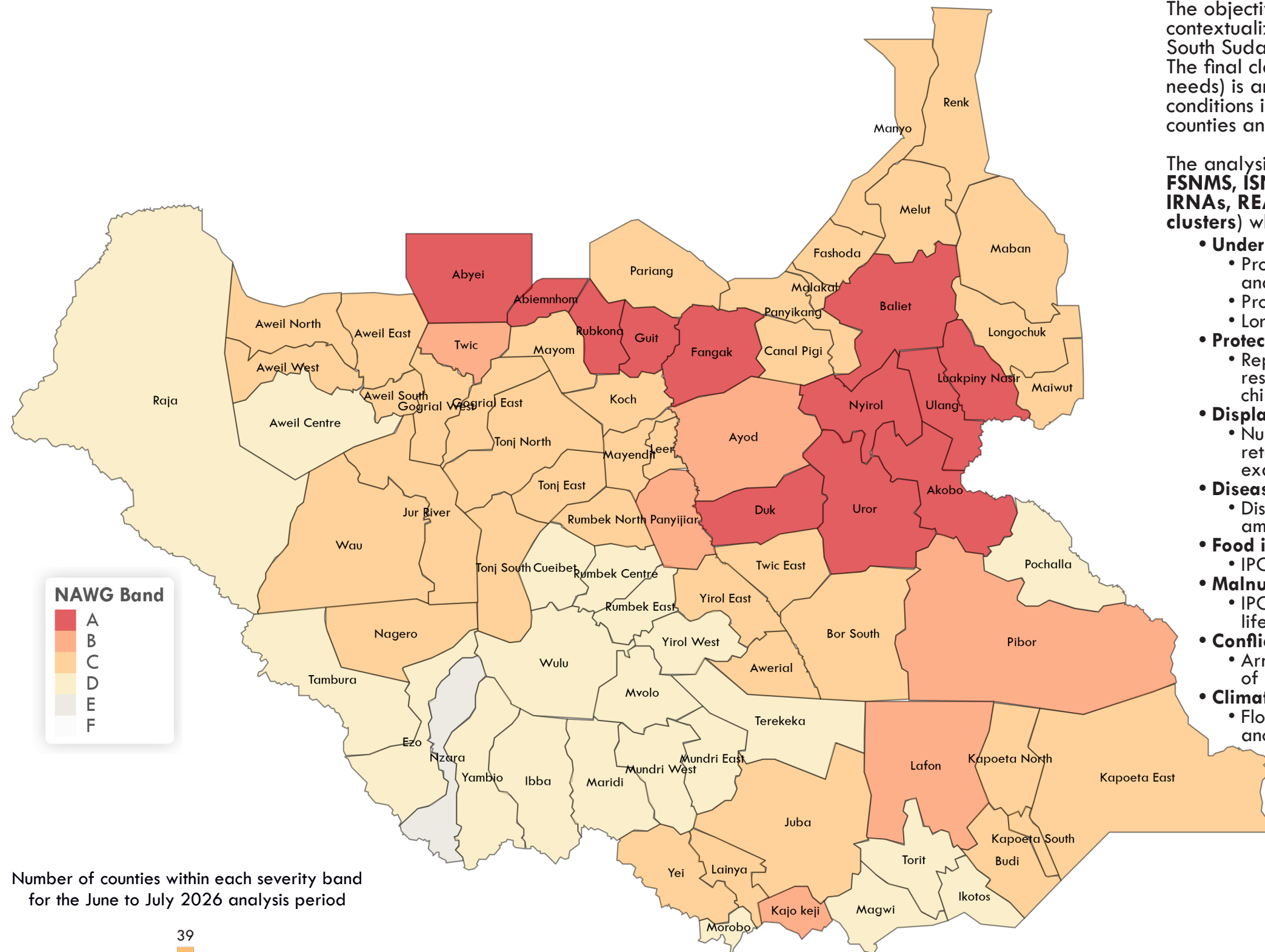
Background

The NAWG meeting was held on August 11, 2026 to discuss the analysis of the **June to July 2026** period.

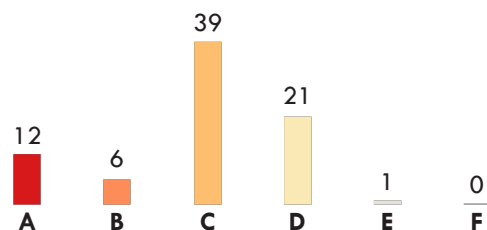
The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of critical life-saving humanitarian needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization by the ICCG. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The analysis encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, ACLED, INSO, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, and data from clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Underlying vulnerability**
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
- **Displacement**
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as a significant number of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used as a proxy for life-threatening acute malnutrition and excess mortality risk.
- **Conflict**
 - Armed conflict events, conflict-related sexual violence, forced recruitment of children, targeted killings of civilians, targeted property destruction
- **Climate shocks**
 - Flood-related displacement, flood extent, drought stress, rainfall anomalies.



Number of counties within each severity band
for the June to July 2026 analysis period



Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B	7 - 7.9	Very severe humanitarian conditions
C	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions
D	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
E	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
F	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Kumudu Sanjeewa (sanjeewa@un.org) or Mary Langan (mary.langan@impact-initiatives.org).

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The June to July 2026 NAWG analysis shows a broadly stable picture. The mean Needs Severity Score moved from 6.31 to 6.29 and 75 of 79 counties held their band since last month's analysis. Conflict events in July were roughly as frequent as in June but were considerably more lethal, carrying roughly twice the fatalities, especially across Greater Tonj and Western Bahr el Ghazal.

The IPC food security and nutrition inputs reflect the April to July 2026 projection. [Early-warning analysis](#) expects nearly 9 million people to need food assistance between June and September. The displacement data covers 1 June to 3 July only and was flagged as incomplete on delivery, so most July movements are carried here by assessments rather than by the displacement dataset.

Drought is the emerging shock, with rainfall deficits described as the driest on historical record and 1.46 million people estimated to be at risk. Cholera stood at 109,908 cumulative cases and 1,720 deaths as of 26 July. Ebola remains a live cross-border risk, as the outbreak in the Democratic Republic of the Congo has spread to Haut-Uele, which shares a long border with Western Equatoria, while an affected health zone in northern Ituri lies about 50 kilometres from the border and has regular commercial links with Yambio.

Counties Facing “Extreme” Humanitarian Conditions

Twelve counties are classified as facing **extreme humanitarian needs (Band A)**: eleven unchanged from the previous analysis cycle, **Akobo, Luakpiny/Nasir, Fangak, Nyirol, Rubkona, Uror, Duk, Ulang, Abiemnhom, Baliel and Abyei**, joined by **Guit**. Akobo alone reaches Band A on score, while Guit was elevated to Band A at the meeting, and the other ten are held there by the IPC methodological restriction. Akobo, Nyirol, Ulang and Nasir face a credible risk of Famine through January 2027.

Discussion and Joint Analysis

- **Guit:** A SMART survey with data collected in mid-June reports global acute malnutrition of 36.2 per cent by weight-for-height and severe acute malnutrition of 9.4 per cent, against 14.7 and 2.6 per cent a year ago. Two qualifiers apply: the estimate by mid-upper arm circumference is much lower at 12.0 per cent, and mortality remains below emergency thresholds. NAWG members present at the meeting agreed the prevalence is consistent with the IPC threshold for Phase 5 acute malnutrition. **Final classification: Elevated from Band C to Band A.**

- **Lafon:** Put forward for discussion after a joint assessment by 15 organisations in late July reported a severe hunger crisis driven by a prolonged dry spell, with widespread crop failure and depleted food stocks. More than 1,200 people reportedly left the county or crossed the border, and several villages were partially deserted. Members reported that malnutrition admission data corroborate the assessment, and that 14,000 people are targeted for food assistance. Reports of hunger-related deaths remain unconfirmed and further assessments are needed. **Final classification: Elevated from Band C to Band B.**
- **Kajo-keji:** Kajo-keji recorded the largest reported single displacement event in the Equatorias this cycle, which the backend analysis datasets did not capture. Fighting along the southern border in mid-July reportedly displaced an estimated 9,100 people from five villages. Displaced families had not returned by late July, and the fighting also disrupted an Ebola screening point in a high-risk county. Members put the displacement at 9,502 people, of whom around 9,000 reportedly remain displaced. **Final classification: Elevated from Band C to Band B.**
- **Jur River:** A joint inter-agency assessment reported 37,191 individuals affected by violence across Wau and Jur River, of whom 19,882 were verified as displaced in makeshift settlements, schools and open fields. The assessment reported no functional health delivery units at five locations, three verified cases of sexual violence, and more than 90 per cent of households facing severe food consumption gaps with no formal distributions active. Displacement tracking captured only the mid-June movements. **Final classification: Elevated from Band D to Band C.**
- **Wau:** Wau was covered in the same joint inter-agency assessment, with 9,609 displaced individuals recorded across three payams, and schools, health outposts and administrative offices reportedly converted into shelters. No displacement was recorded in the county by displacement tracking despite the verified caseload, which contributed to the decision to elevate it. Members reported food shortages, and that displaced people are sheltering in schools so no education is taking place. The displacement dynamics were described as similar to Jur River. **Final classification: Elevated from Band D to Band C.**
- **Ayod:** Ayod recorded the largest needs severity score increase nationally and moved up a band on disease and climate signals, with 425 km² flooded in July, the largest of any county. Protection monitoring rated Ayod among the four most severe counties nationally, although no conflict incidents were recorded there in the period. Members reported that Ayod received the highest number of displaced people among the Jonglei counties over June and July. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**

- **Panyijiar:** Panyijiar's needs severity score rose from the previous analysis period on conflict and climate signals. It was the focal point of intensified raiding along the Unity to Lakes border in July. Coordinated attacks on cattle camps in the Bar grazing area on 16 and 17 July reportedly killed 16 people, and a separate attack inside the county on 17 July reportedly killed 17 people. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**
- **Longochuk:** An inter-cluster assessment in June identified more than 22,000 people in need of urgent assistance in Udier Payam. Health facilities are reportedly short of medical supplies, there is no functional cold chain, nutrition stabilisation centres are reportedly not operating and every school in the payam is reportedly closed. Members reported continuing instability, including clashes in the week before the meeting. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**
- **Twic:** Twic holds the highest needs severity score of any county outside Band A, under sustained cross-border cattle-raiding pressure, with incidents frequent but largely non-lethal. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B.**
- **Raja:** Raja's needs severity score fell from the previous analysis period on a reduced protection signal, partly offset by a rise in its climate shocks signal, leaving it just below the Band C threshold. The evidence base is thin: conflict monitoring recorded a single event and one fatality, and independent reporting remained limited. **Final classification: Maintained in Band D.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

Counties are flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to track the situation and share relevant information. **All Band A counties remain under close monitoring by default, and Lafon, Ayod and Raja were added during the meeting.**

- **Greater Tonj needs close monitoring due to increased violence.** Attacks in early July reportedly caused 74 deaths and displaced 40,000 people across the three counties and Twic. Tonj North recorded the second-highest fatality total nationally, after Akobo, according to conflict monitoring.
- **Cholera and flooding remain concentrated in Unity, Lakes and Jonglei.** Mayom and Leer are in the oral cholera vaccination campaign, Renk holds the second-highest diarrhoeal caseload nationally alongside continued cross-border arrivals, and Aweril continues to report new cholera cases. Twic East and Panyikang are flagged for riverine insecurity and access denial.
- **Drought and cross-border disease risks warrant monitoring in the east and south.** The Kapoeta counties and Budi form the core of the drought caseload, with the country's first anticipatory action plan activated. Terekeka, Bor South and Pibor are also among the most exposed, and the Rumbek counties recorded the highest cropland stress nationally. Western Equatoria remains the frontline for Ebola risk, and abductions of humanitarian staff continue in Yei and Morobo.